

Research Report

Sales Assisted Loan Application

Education Loan, Home Loan

Usability

Testing

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Research Goal

The study aims to understand the usability and overall experience of the sales-assisted home and education loan journey, focusing on how agents navigate, interpret, and complete each flow, how it fits into their existing way of working, and what effect it has on their efficiency, confidence, and task completion.

1. Uncover how **intuitive and seamless the end-to-end journey feels** for agents handling loan applications.
2. Identify **moments of hesitation, confusion, or extra effort** that could slow down task completion.
3. Understand **whether the digital process supports agents in meeting customer needs faster** or more accurately.
4. Capture **agents' perceptions of how this journey compares with their current workflow**.

User Profile and methodology

S.No	Staff Name	Designation	Loan Type	Location
1	Vikram	RO	Home Loan	Thane
2	Badal Singh	RO	Home Loan	Thane
3	Jitendra	SM	Home Loan	Thane
4	Aboli (& 3-4 others)	ASM and team	Home Loan	Nagpur
5	Umesh	RO	Home Loan	Thane
6	Anoop	RO	Education Loan	Thane
7	Anuj Kekre & Team	SM and team	Education Loan	Indore
8	Nikhil Sharma	RO	Education Loan	Bhopal

~30-45 minute usability testing sessions and focus group discussions were conducted with Relationship Officers and Sales Managers at Axis Loan Centers across locations.

Section-wise Insights

*Section-wise Flows Across the Sales-Assisted Loan
Journey*

New Application

While this section's **flow was clear** and users rated both ease of **interaction and confidence at 4.8/5**, **half** the users struggled to find the **Start/Resume Application** button, as it was **overshadowed** by other page elements.

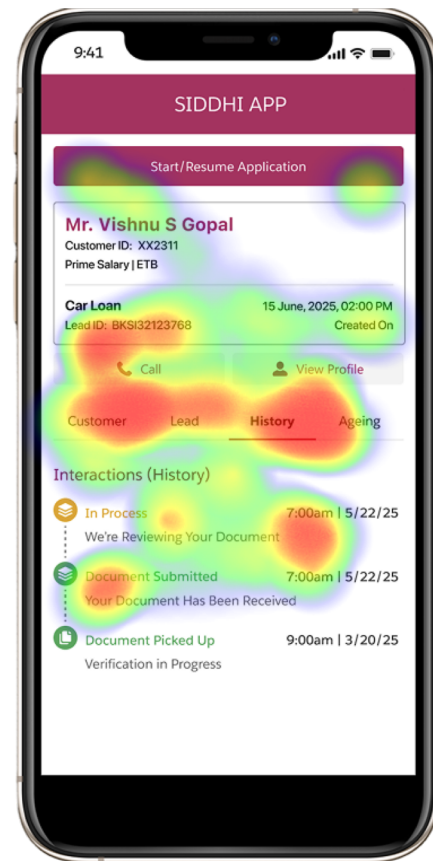
Very Difficult



Very Easy

4.8

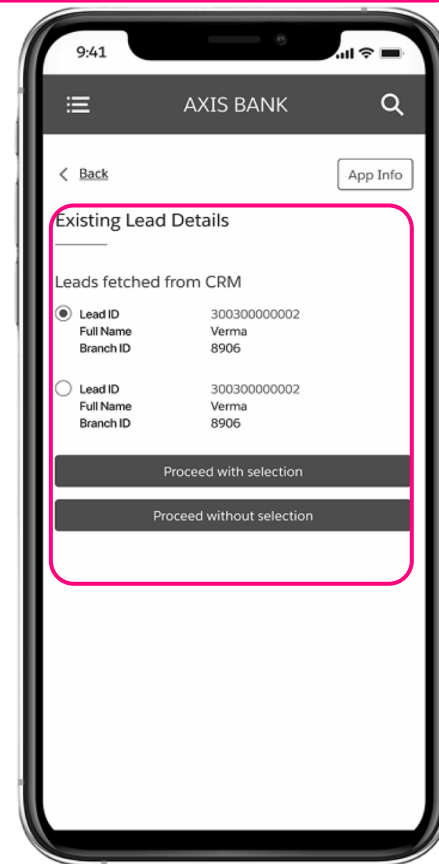
"Sab saaf saaf shabdo mein likha hai"
- Relationship Officer (Home Loan)



Notional Heatmap

Questionnaire

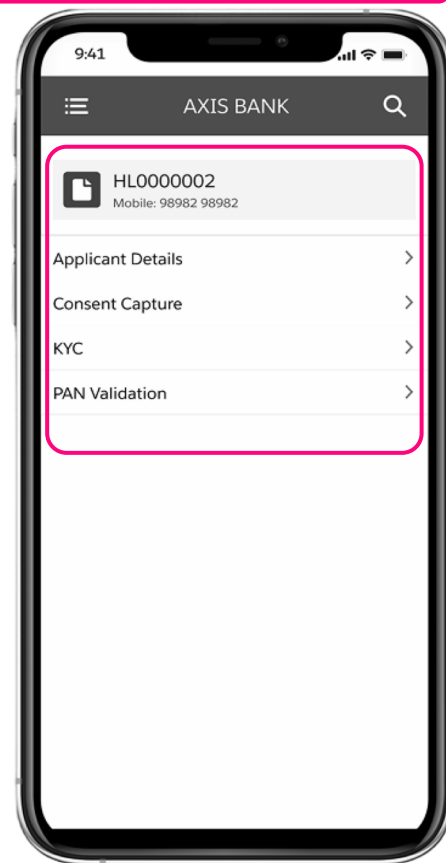
- Users **responded positively** to the section (avg rating 4/5) and showed **curiosity about whether information-entry fields on screens would be prefilled**.
- Some agents expect details to be fetched through **CRM** instead of filling in the questionnaire. They expect that the details have already been captured by the branch when generating the lead and refilling those details feels redundant.



Screen showing Existing Lead Details

Application Login

- Most users **did not find the section's flow long** or cumbersome; most felt all steps were necessary and justified.
 - Several users **struggled to understand status of the steps** (what was completed vs pending) **and the order of actions**. Visual indicators (ticks, progress markers) were expected but missing or inconsistent.
-
- All users **correctly interpreted "Applicant 1"** as the main or primary applicant, showing good clarity of terminology.
 - Some users **expected consent capture to come after KYC and PAN validation**, as done in current workflows. This indicates a gap between the prototype logic and users' mental models.
 - Few users raised relevant **questions around handling NRI customers and NTB cases**, indicating a need for clearer guidance or system handling for these scenarios.



KYC

- Several users **missed or skipped the Confirm Details** selection, assuming it was optional due to the **absence of a star mark or explicit prompt**, thereby indicating a need for clearer visual or textual cues for mandatory actions.
- The alert copy ("**wait 5 mins**") was misinterpreted by some users as a literal waiting period, suggesting the need for clearer phrasing.
- Despite minor confusions, users found the overall flow easy to follow and logical. (avg rating: 4.5-5).

"Mujhe strike hi nahi hua. Options were visible but I thought it was an optional step"

- Sales Manager (Home Loan)

03602/198
9:41

AXIS BANK

Gender

Address Details

Fiat No./House No./Building Name
101 Prime Regency ✓

Street Road Area
101 Prime Regency ✓

Alert

You have not completed 5 mins to retry
Please retry again after sometime

Ok

his place and you have to...

PIN code
30015

City
Prime

State
Delhi

Confirm details

☒ Details are accurate and up-to-date
☐ Current address needs to be updated
☐ Both addresses needs to be updated

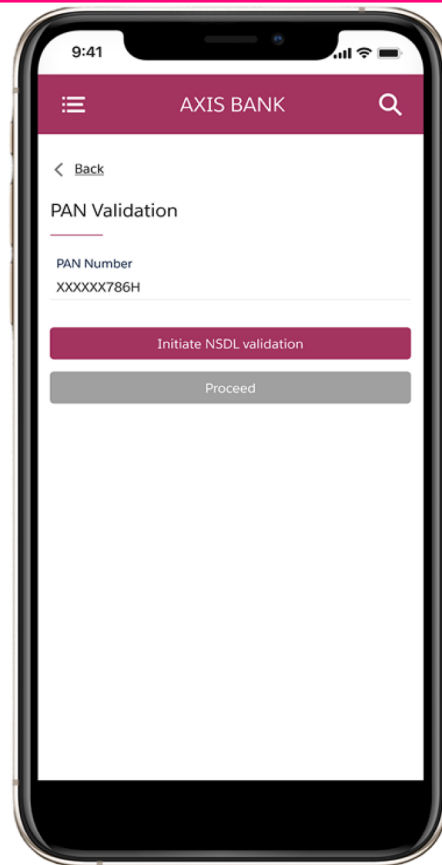
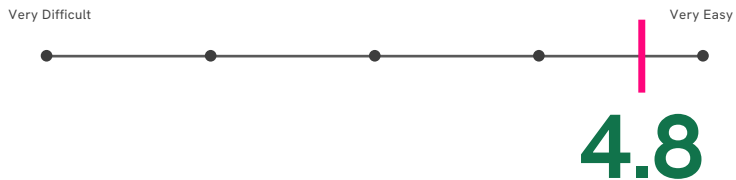
Confirm Details and Proceed

No Clarity on Mandatory Fields

PAN Validation

Most users said the **section's flow aligned well with their expectations**, reinforcing that the structure and logic feel natural.

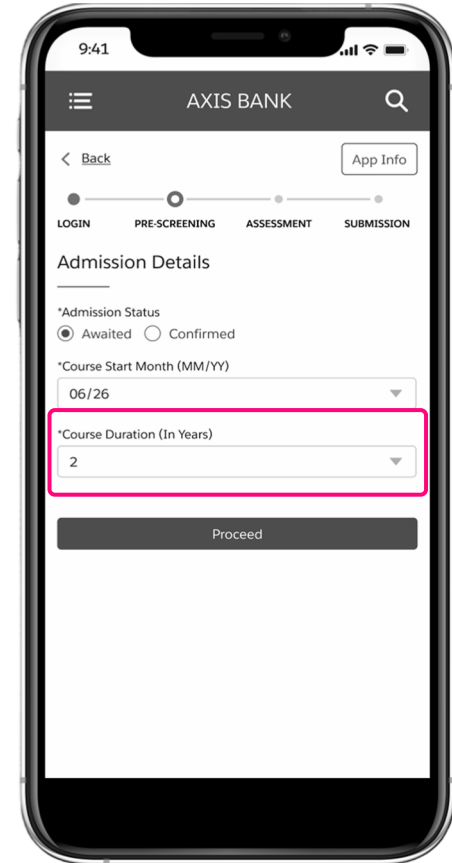
- One user highlighted that minor applicants often don't have a PAN, suggesting a skip or alternate option for NSDL verification to accommodate such cases.



No Alternate Path for Applicants without PAN

Admission Details (Education Loan)

- One user highlighted that course durations aren't always whole numbers (e.g., 2 years 6 months), suggesting the **need to allow month-level entry** instead of fixed year values.
- Some users appreciated the Institute ID field and suggested that entering it should **auto-fetch related details**, reducing manual input.
- They also requested an option to **manually enter the pincode**, indicating a preference for flexibility when auto-fetch or system lookup doesn't apply.



The screenshot displays the Axis Bank mobile application interface for the 'Admission Details' section. At the top, the status bar shows the time as 9:41 and signal strength. The app header includes the Axis Bank logo and a search icon. Below the header, a progress bar indicates the current step is 'PRE-SCREENING', with other steps being 'LOGIN', 'ASSESSMENT', and 'SUBMISSION'. The 'Admission Details' form contains the following fields:

- *Admission Status: Radio buttons for 'Awaited' (selected) and 'Confirmed'.
- *Course Start Month (MM/YY): A dropdown menu showing '06/26'.
- *Course Duration (In Years): A dropdown menu showing '2'. This field is highlighted with a red rectangular box.

A 'Proceed' button is located at the bottom of the form.

Month-level Input for Course Duration Missing.

Pre-Screening

- Users found the **flow simple and intuitive** (avg rating: ~4.5–5). Many appreciated the eligibility check feature, calling it helpful and **trust-building** when interacting with customers.
- Most users **correctly identified the 'i' icon as an information tooltip**, drawing familiarity from other apps. However, a few users either hadn't seen it before or were unsure of its purpose, suggesting a minor need for standardization or better cues.
- Few users **raised edge-case concerns**, such as 'Guarantor' not being applicable for certain loan types and **what to do in case of missing employer names** in system listings.

"Just one doubt, will the companies under employer be under our listing? because now sometimes some companies are not listed in the system so we have to ask for additional details from the applicants"

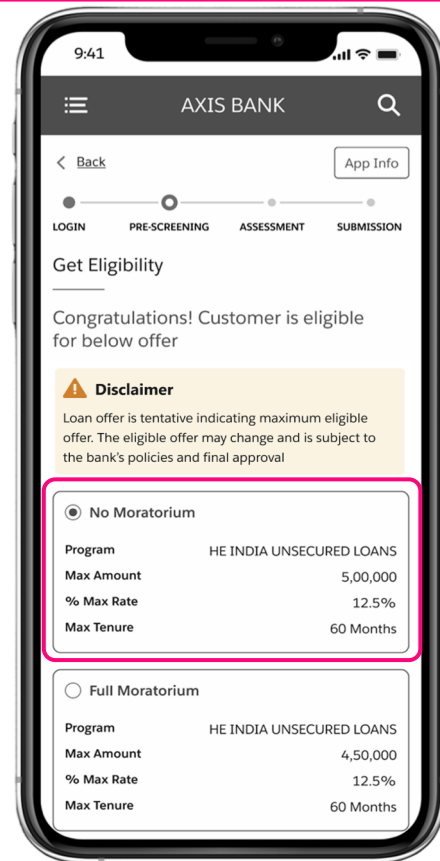
- Relationship Officer (Education Loan)

Get Eligibility

- Notification was largely seen as helpful, especially by users new to the flow, they look for hints or instructions to guide them. However, **more experienced users either ignored it or questioned its need**, saying they'd only notice it if they were stuck.
- Some users also struggled with the content itself. **"No Moratorium"** was **not understood by a few**, while others familiar with it found the screen irrelevant or misplaced and it was something that **should've been handled earlier in CRM**.
- Comparisons to existing systems (like iLens) show users expect such guidance to appear after entering income or at points where it helps decide the next step, not before.

"I'm familiar with this but iski kya zarurat hai. Hume PA PQ letter toh chahiye nahi. Toh tentative screening dekh k karenge kya? Cuz we want submission so this screen according to me is irrelevant. Probably MLP has this currently...But see if the application is of 10lacs mereko kya fayda 5lac ka screening dekh k? Ye pre-screening CRM me honi chahiye thi jab hum kisi customer ki lead dalte hai, tab ye sab kaam aa sakta hai"

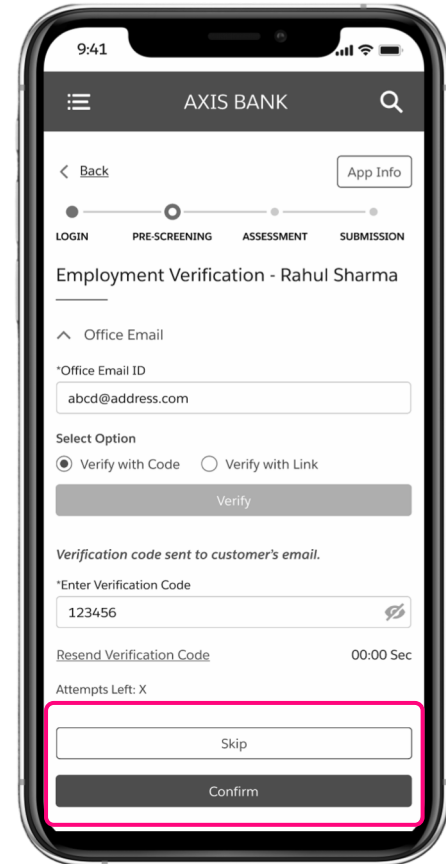
- Assistant Sales Manager (Home Loan)



'No Moratorium' Unclear or Misplaced.

Applicant Details: Employment Verification

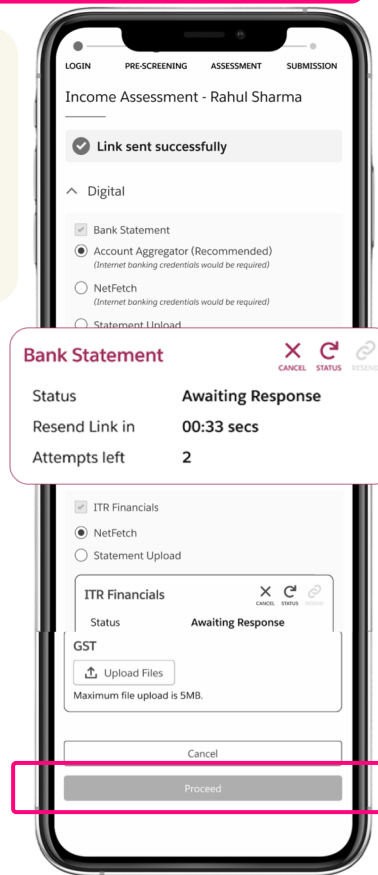
- Some **users were unsure how to proceed** when the company wasn't listed or when the applicant was a student or self-employed, expecting clearer fallback options like manual entry or alternate paths.
- One user noted a **mismatch with their current process** their existing form captures both Gross and Net Monthly Income for offer decisions, while the new flow only asks for Gross, raising concerns about offer accuracy.
- There were also **UI-driven slips** where one user **chose 'Skip' simply because it appeared first**, suggesting that CTA hierarchy may be unintentionally guiding behavior.



CTA Order Confused Users.

Applicant Details: New Income Assessment

- Most users were **positively surprised by the Account Aggregator feature**, calling it time-saving, efficient, and a **great add-on**. It was perceived as a modern improvement over existing processes like iLens (ICICI), enhancing credibility and ease of work.
- While some users clearly understood the Account Aggregator concept, others were **unsure what it meant or how it worked**.
- Most users **correctly interpreted the meaning of status indicators and action icons** (refresh, resend, cancel) but often only after interacting or being guided.
- A few users **missed why the Proceed CTA was disabled when GST wasn't selected or status was pending**, showing a need for stronger feedback cues such as an asterisk, tooltip etc.
- One user **appreciated having both digital and physical upload options**, seeing it as practical flexibility for when network or system issues arise.



CTA State Unclear

Applicant Details: Additional Sources of Income

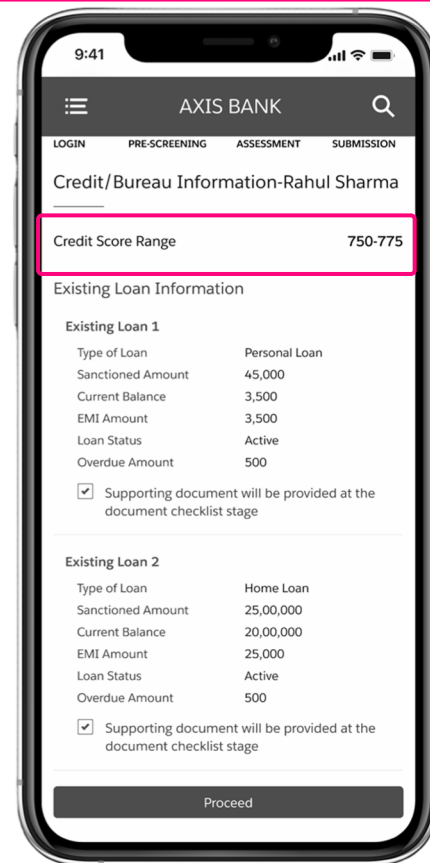
- Most users said the section's flow matched their expectations however **minor uncertainties still came up**. One relatively new SM **wasn't sure whether she had to take any action or just proceed**, indicating that while the flow logic is sound, the cues or prompts for user action could be clearer.
- A small point of friction appeared around redundant data entry **one user questioned why details already captured earlier were being asked again**.

"Already added before, why ask again, capture from there"

- Relationship Officer (Home Loan)

Applicant Details: Credit Bureau Information

- This section exceeded expectations, with users expressing **surprise and excitement at seeing CIBIL details within the app** which came across as a **valuable addition** that directly addressed their day-to-day pain points.
- Most users found this feature game-changing, helping them **make confident, data-backed decisions, avoid rejections, and close discussions faster** with both customers and credit managers.
- One user **clicked through without reading**, showing high excitement but also **low attention in some cases suggesting the need for a brief visual cue** or summary to ensure critical information (like CIBIL) isn't skipped.
- One **user raised edge-case questions**, such as what happens when the customer has no prior loans and the CIBIL score is negative. This shows need for clarity on how such exceptions will be handled.



CIBIL Status Lacks Clear Visual Cue

Applicant Details: Additional Details

- SMs suggested **moving email verification to the start of the journey**, since **many customers** (especially from Tier 3-4 cities, government jobs, or low-network areas) **often have inactive emails**. Discovering that late in the flow feels like wasted effort, and **early verification could help decide if a physical login route is needed**.
- Another **user noticed field inconsistency** “**Father’s Name**” and “**Spouse’s Name**” appear in one order but reverse in the next step.

9:41

AXIS BANK

Additional Details - Rahul Sharma

Personal Email

*Personal Email ID
abc@address.com

Personal Details

*Family Income (p.a. in INR)
70,00,000

*Mother's Full Name
Prem Lata Kumari

☒ Father's Name ☐ Spouse Name

*Spouse/Father's Full Name
Ajeet Rai Kumar

Marital Status
Unmarried

*No. of Dependent(s)
2

*Religion
Hindu

*Educational Qualification
Graduate

Inconsistent Input Field Order Across Steps.

Applicant Details: Reference Details

- One user pointed out that while the **contact number** is entered while filling details, it **doesn't appear on the next screen**.

9:41

AXIS BANK

< Back App Info

LOGIN PRE-SCREENING ASSESSMENT SUBMISSION

Reference Details 1

*Reference Name
Ajeet Rai Kumar

*Relation
Father

Country Code *Mobile Number
+91 98890 98890

*Flat No / House No / Building Name
101 Prime Regency

*Street / Road / Area
Curly Street

*Village / Town / District
Pune

Landmark
Near Post Office

*Pincode
300215

Add Reference

Reference Details 1

Reference Name	Ajeet Rai Kumar
Relation	Father
Flat No / House No / Building Name	101 Prime Regency
Street / Road / Area	Curly Street
Village / Town / District	Pune
Landmark	Near Post Office
Pincode	300215
City	Pune
State	Maharashtra

Proceed

Contact Detail Missing in Subsequent Screen.

Course Fee Details (Education Loans)

- Users saw the Course Fee Detail section as a **much-needed improvement that removes the manual currency conversion** they currently do. Allowing direct input in USD makes the process faster and simpler.
- One user asked **if the conversion shown is real-time or tentative**, suggesting that clarity on data accuracy will be key for full trust and adoption.

"This is a nice improvement and much sought one, will help us leave that manual conversion that we do now, but will it show data in real time or tentative?"

- Relationship Officer (Education Loan)

Moratorium & Subsidy (Education Loans)

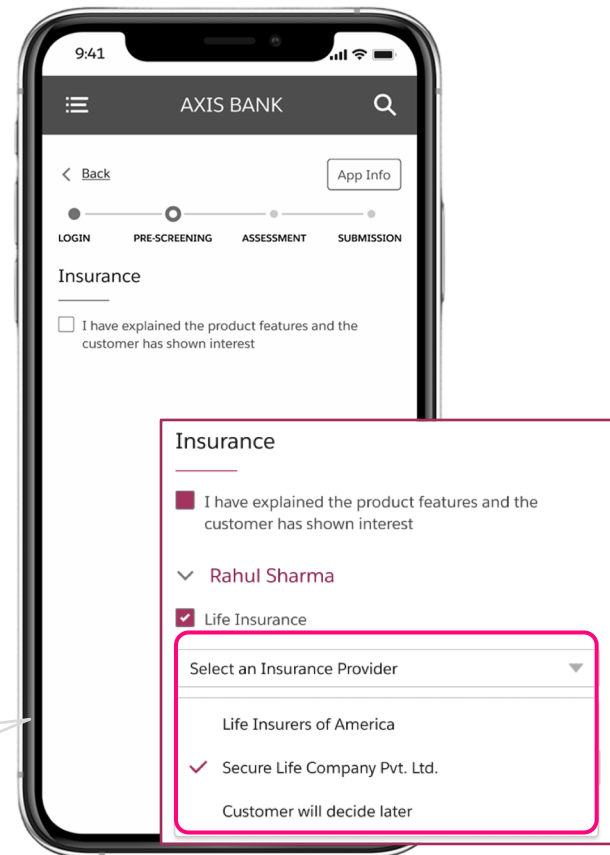
- Users viewed the Moratorium & Subsidy section as **largely irrelevant in current scenarios**. They mentioned such cases are rare and that customers who typically apply have higher incomes, making them ineligible for subsidies.
- Some noted that while they **usually skip this step in the current process**, the **new flow doesn't offer a skip** option.
- Others **assumed the section is kept for future use**, not something they actively engage with today.

Insurance

- Most users felt that the **insurance step should be optional** and more clearly presented as a choice.
- Many said it **currently feels forced**, especially since the option **“Customer Will Decide Later”** appears only **after progressing further**. They expect to see this choice upfront on the first screen, not hidden in a dropdown.
- Several **users tried to skip or back out of the insurance screen** but couldn't find an easy way to do so, leading to confusion.
- While a few users liked that the **“decide later” option exists** (and noted it matches what they have in Omega), the **current placement makes it less discoverable**.

"I think ek Tab hona chahiye tha ki customer is not interested at this time. 90% of customers don't confirm immediately, they say ki we will see and later choose insurance"

- Sales Manager (Home Loan)



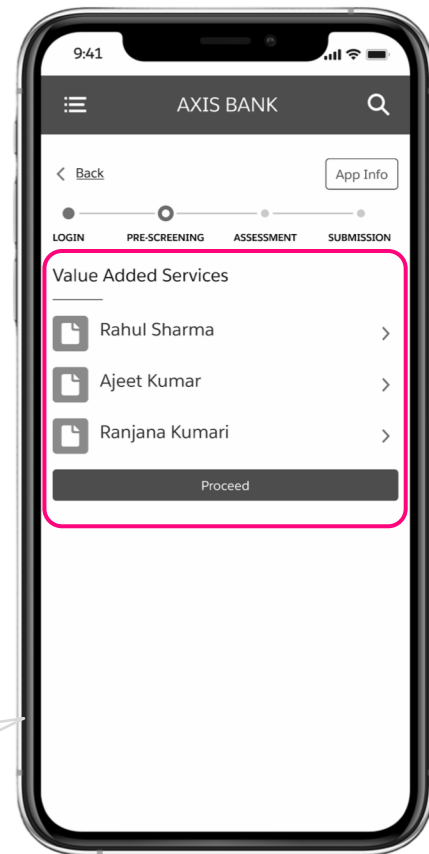
'Decide later' Option Not Easily Discoverable.

Value Added Services

- Most users correctly **recognised this as a cross-sell section** and responded positively to the idea, seeing it as a familiar and useful addition.
- A few **users were unsure at first what the section was about** or **whether the listed names referred to the same or different customers**. They suggested adding clear visual indicators (e.g., labels or highlights) to distinguish applicant and co-applicant.
- One user also emphasised that **cross-sell should remain optional, especially where insurance is included, to avoid the perception of being forced**. while one user didn't understand the "Value Added Services" section at all, indicating a need for clearer labeling or brief explanations.

"We are Cross Selling our products. this should be optional too and it again has Insurance in it"

- Relationship Officer (Education Loan)



Unclear Applicant vs Co-Applicant Distinction.

Login Fees

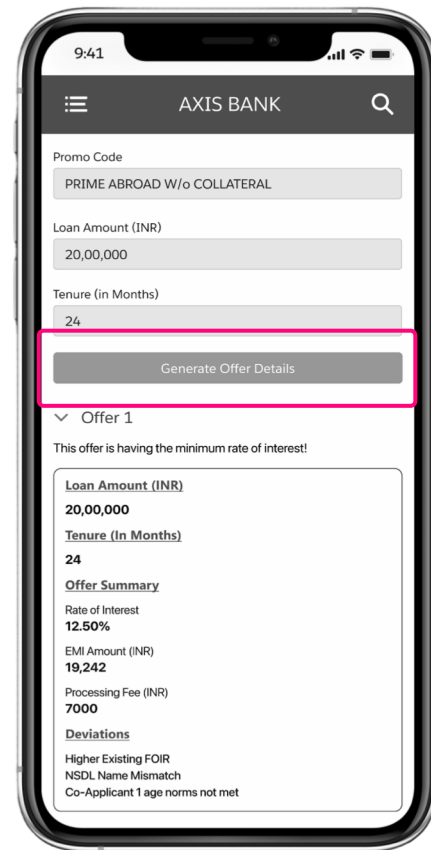
- Most users clearly understood that **“Check Status” would show whether the fee payment was successful or pending**, and overall found the flow easy to follow.
- However, several process-related questions came up where **users wanted to know if fees can be edited, reused if an application corrupts**, or changed at this stage.
- A few users also **questioned the timing of fee collection**, suggesting it **should happen after sanction** rather than before.
- In one case, the **user clicked Proceed without checking status and only realised it through a pop-up**, indicating CTA hierarchy could better guide the expected order of action.

“Also if customer pays the fees and later the application corrupts, will this same fee be repurposed when he reapplies?”

- Sales Manager (Home Loan)

Offer

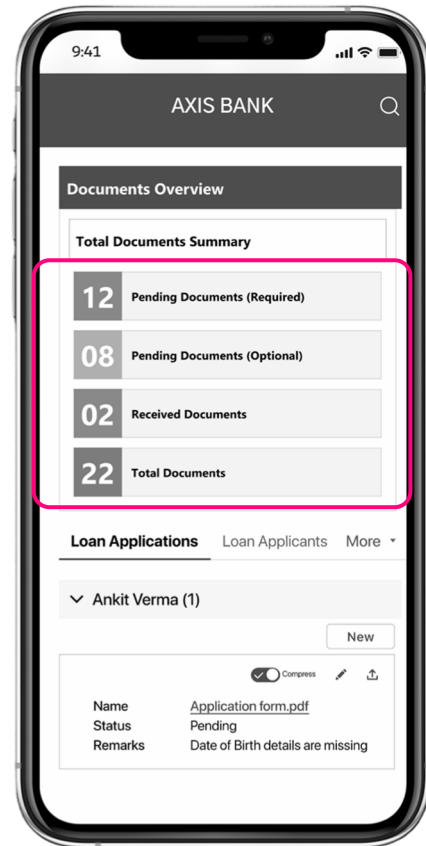
- Some users **generally understood this screen as a place to view and compare different loan offers**, something they found useful for discussing options directly with customers.
- One user appreciated that **deviations and multiple offers were visible on-screen** and felt this **could replace the manual process** they currently follow using printed product sheets.
- However, despite the intent being good, **the interaction flow was unclear**. Many **didn't know how to proceed after seeing the offers**, key CTAs like Generate Offer, Compare, or Save **weren't intuitive**, and users couldn't tell what action to take next.
- Some **users also questioned the need for this step in an online journey**, calling it **"unnecessary" or "too long,"** especially since **offers shown are not final**. The lack of a Skip option reinforced the feeling of being stuck.
- Those who eventually figured it out liked the comparison feature but **needed guidance to discover it**.



CTA State Unclear

Document Checklist

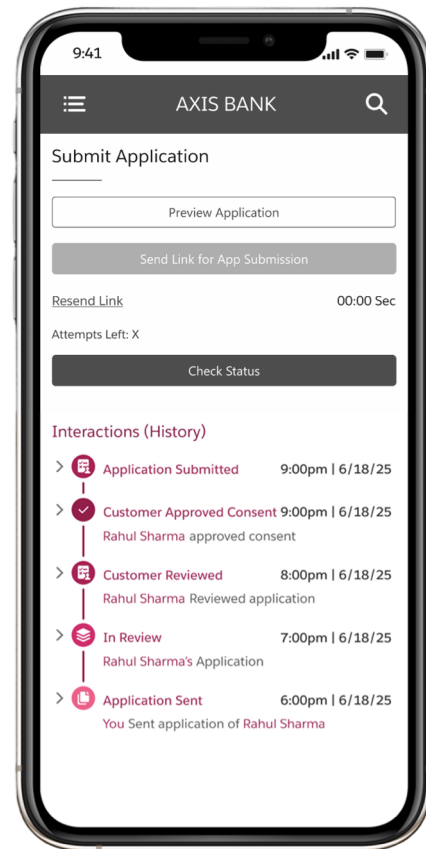
- Most users **were confused about what action to take next**, while many **tried clicking on the “Pending Documents” count** or colored boxes expecting them to open an upload tab. The **“New” CTA at the bottom was often overlooked** or discovered only after trial and error.
- The **numeric document status boxes (e.g., 12 Pending)** were frequently **mistaken for buttons**, suggesting a mismatch between visual design and interaction expectation.
- Users **struggled to locate where to upload pending documents**. Scroll dependency and lack of explicit prompts led to uncertainty.
- Elements like **“Approved by”** and options under **“More”** were not **understood**, leading users to guess their function indicating a need for clearer labeling or contextual help.
- A few **users expressed concern about losing partially filled data**, not realizing that **Resume Application exists**. This highlights the need to surface progress-saving cues more prominently.



Numeric Status Boxes Mistaken for Interactive Buttons.

Submit Application

- While users could locate and check status easily, **most did not notice or understand the color change**, interpreting it as decorative. They **relied on timestamps** instead suggesting the need for stronger visual contrast or legends to make status colors meaningful.
- Few Users **expected to view application progress across all stages** (e.g., Operations, Credit teams) from the same interface, **indicating a need for centralized**, real-time status visibility.
- Some **users were unsure when the process was complete** and what happened after actions like "Check Status." They expected clearer confirmation (e.g., success message or visual cue) and better guidance on next steps, similar to their current workflows.
- Users found the **digital version faster and easier** than current manual methods involving Ops team coordination.
- One user wanted small enhancements, such as: A **"Check Current Status"** button for direct access, Option to review applications before submission and Ability to re-upload incorrect documents without restarting the case.



Sourcing Details

- Users were largely fine with the placement of the sourcing information, though opinions differed slightly.

- One user appreciated that it appears at the end, noting that if it were at the start, it might require multiple OTP requests, which would slow things down.
- Another suggested it could also appear at the start, but without a strong reason indicating neutrality rather than dissatisfaction.

Good it is kept at the end. Sourcing info if it is at the start will we have to ask OTP for everything from the customer?

- Relationship Officer (Home Loan)

"Aise laga hi nahi ki maine process kiya aur wo last me complete hua. Qki agar main koi case process karta hu toh file number k sath uska congratulation ya koi status aa jaega ki ye application number ya app ID hai...barcode bhi nahi aya jo baad me CPC ko jata hai."

- Sales Manager (Home Loan)

Executive Summary

- Users consistently rated flows between **4-5/5**, describing them as **simple, logical, and faster** than existing systems.
- The mobile-first design is seen as a major upgrade, allowing **end-to-end completion at customer sites** and reducing back-and-forth with Ops teams.
- Users frequently missed cues for **status, completion, and mandatory fields**, suggesting a need for **clearer progress indicators, tick marks, and confirmation messages**.
- Buttons like *Start/Resume Application*, *Proceed*, and *Check Status* were often **overlooked or clicked in the wrong order**, showing that **visual prominence and sequencing** need refinement.
- Users repeatedly asked for **auto-fetch, prefilled fields, and editable fallback options** (e.g., manual pincode entry).
- In past research for other products, users had also strongly recommended **auto pre-fill and data fetching capabilities** (like competitors). This ask resurfaced here as well however, we were informed earlier that this is **currently not supported technically**, though users continue to see it as a major value-add.
- **Offer comparison and generation screens** were unclear; users didn't know which action to take next or why the step existed, making it feel longer than needed.

Executive Summary

- Terms like “No Moratorium” and “Wait 5 mins” were **misinterpreted**, pointing to the need for **simpler phrasing and contextual tooltips**.
- Steps like **insurance and offer comparison** felt **forced**; users want these to be clearly **optional with upfront choices**.
- While most found the flows intuitive, some mentioned that **less tech-savvy staff will need quick training or onboarding support**.
- Users raised practical scenarios (e.g., **NRI, NTB, minors without PAN, missing employer names**) that need clearer handling or alternate paths.
- Elements like **Account Aggregator and in-app CIBIL display** stood out as **high-impact** that build trust and speed decision-making.
- **Document upload flow** caused repeated confusion as users didn’t realize where to upload, mistook summary boxes for buttons, and overlooked the CTAs.
- While this was a **prototype usability test**, real-world experience may vary due to factors like **network reliability, keypad behavior, API calls, and auto-fetch performance**, which were not fully active in this environment.

Key Learnings

- Being able to complete the entire process on mobile, from eligibility check to document upload was viewed as a major time and effort saver, reducing dependency on **Omega or desktop-based tools**.
- Staff expect a tangible reduction in turnaround time (TAT), fewer errors, and the ability to handle more logins per day.
- A few operational steps like stamp paper, legal, or technical checks still require manual handling suggesting the need for clarity or digital alternatives.
- The new flow addresses existing pain points like document exchanges. Still, users suggest reducing multiple links/OTPs to avoid customer friction.
- Overall sentiment is anticipatory and some users are eager for rollout, provided there's sufficient support, smooth app performance, and clarity on integration with existing systems.



Thank You